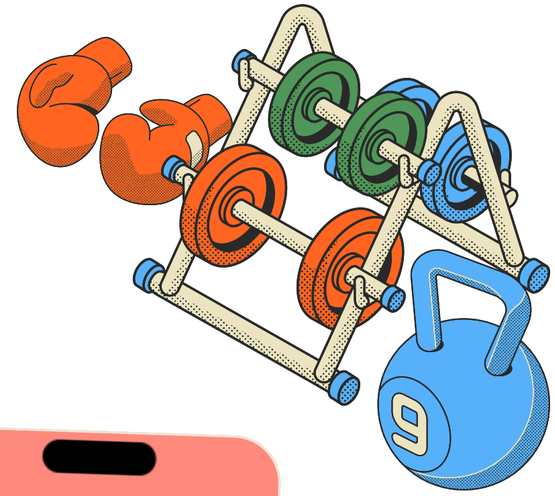
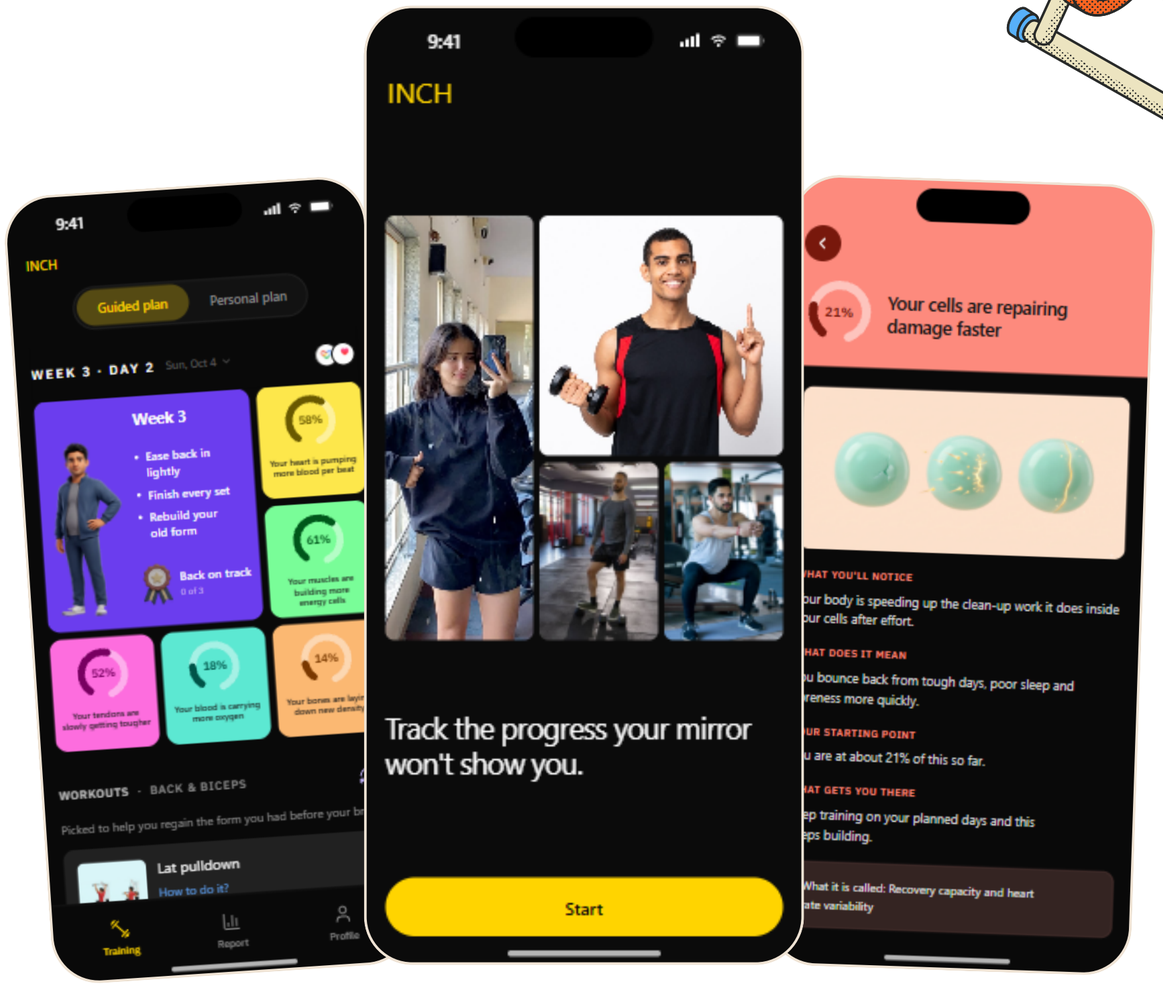
INCH

Stronger Every Day



Celebrate every change
Even the invisible ones



User experience design

Solo project - Mainak

Timeline - 4 weeks

Overview

INCH is a fitness application that tracks the users' workouts and overall lifestyle to produce reports on the invisible micro positive changes happening inside the body, to give the early gym goers a sense of success in their new fitness journey

Let's see how I arrived here ⟶

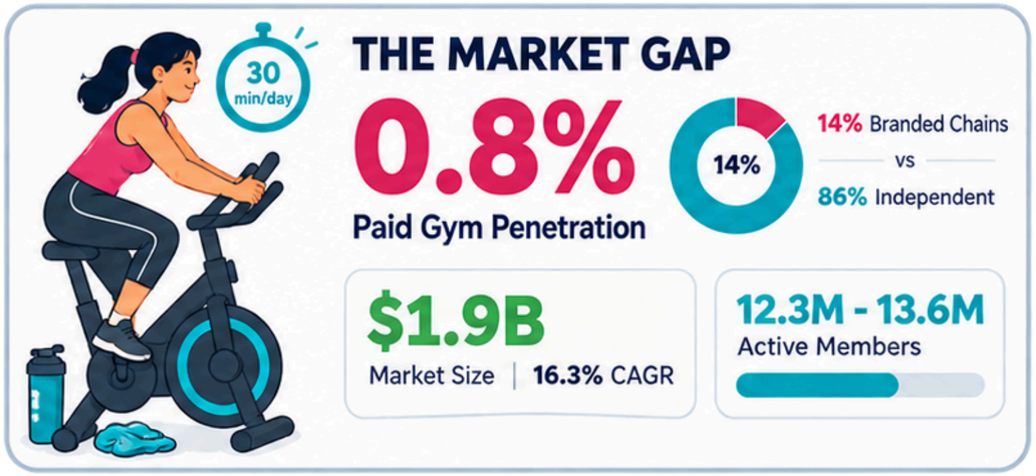
Problem Area

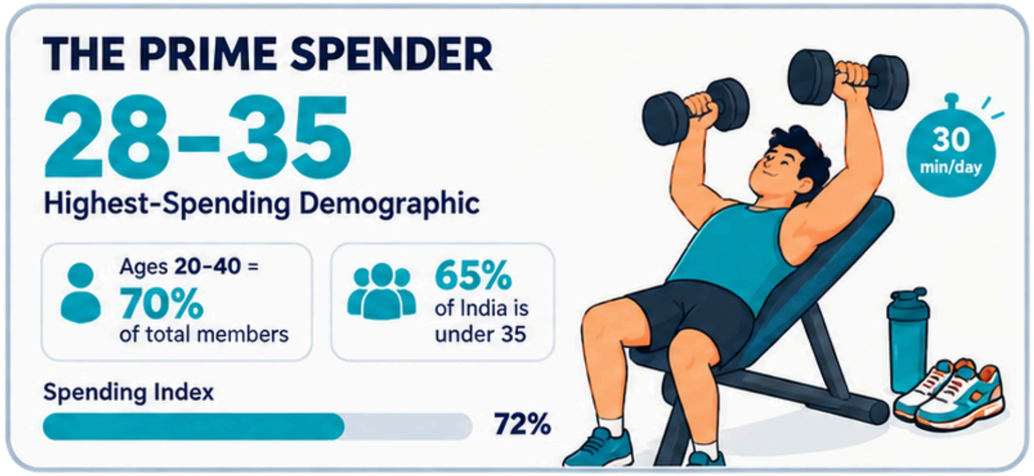
More than 50% of new gym members discontinue going to the gym within the first 3 months

Commercial gyms face a severe retention crisis, with most beginners quitting within three months and **peak churn hitting right around Month 1.**

This drop-off is driven by a stark timeline mismatch. Visible muscle hypertrophy requires a **minimum of 12 to 16 weeks** of continuous stimulus, while any substantial physical transformation takes significantly longer.

Quantitative Research





Quantitative Research

An extensive analysis of what are the current available products available for gym goers

Manual Logging Apps

Effort Tracking Only

Feels like data entry; numbers without bodily meaning.

AI Form Correction

Movement Accuracy Only

Zero motion layer; doesn't adjust when workouts are missed.

Social / Gamified Platforms

Short-Term Motivation Only

Built on outside rewards: one broken streak feels like failure, and motivation fades once the novelty wears off.

Human-Coaching Apps

Personal Guidance Only

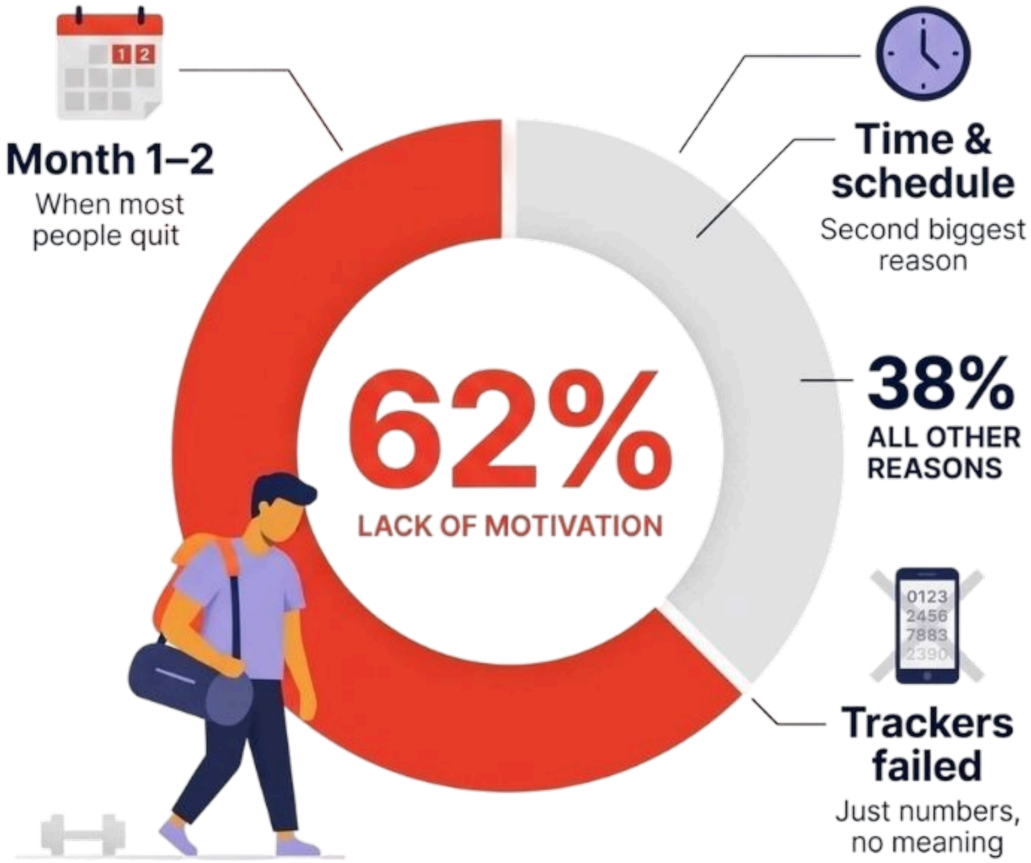
The coach isn't physically there, so the accountability and push of training beside someone is lost.

All the available products solve for the external troubles; nothing solves for the internal state of gym goers

An oppurtunity exists to cater to gym goers which will serve their interests for the long term

Qualitative Research (N=13)

13 dropped out gym goers were interviewed. Asked for the single main reason they stopped going. A clear majority named lack of motivation



Psychology suggests the lack of motivation stems from the lack of feedback on efforts put in

Goal-setting theory suggests that when someone attains a goal it raises their self-efficacy and that, in turn, reinforces their motivation to continue.

The gym goers expect results rapidly but the results do not show and therefore their efforts do not get justified

Insights from research

Positive physiological changes begin within the first week of gymming but remain imperceptible to observation.

Psychological research points towards increase in sustained activity when improvements, even micro are shown

The narrative of positive change relies solely on massive physique changes, which aren't scientifically feasible within 2–3 months.

Major gym counts and footfalls come from metro cities.

Major gym dropouts is contributed by people aged 22-35

Primary research

Persona 1

Rohit Verma, 24

Junior tech analyst, Chandigarh

Rohit joined the gym a couple of weeks ago to get fit and improve his physique. With a full-time job, he can only dedicate three days a week to working out. He doesn’t have a trainer, but he has a paid workout-tracking subscription to monitor each session. He lives alone in a rented flat.

Goals

- Gain muscles and have a lean physique as fast as possible
- Get atleast 3 days of workouts every week
- Get guidance on how to get to the goal basis the 3 days of workout

Pain points

- Discipline fades away after initial start due to lack of visible results or improvements
- Tracking app shows metrics but doesn't explain imrovement

Persona 2

Nithin Kapse, 33

Project manager, Mumbai

Nithin has started working out to get back in shape and loose fat. His routine involves high stakes decision making at work, managing his domestic life with his wife, and actively investing in the stock market. He works out 4 days per week with colleagues, learning from them instead of a personal trainer.

Goals

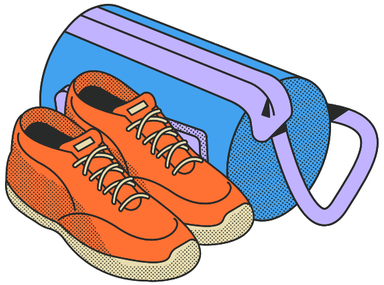
- Loose fat as early as possible and look younger
- Take out time for gym atleast 4 days of the week

Pain points

- Gaps caused due to other life responsibilities disrupts his routine & motivation for gym
- No real results are observed infront of the mirror anytime soon

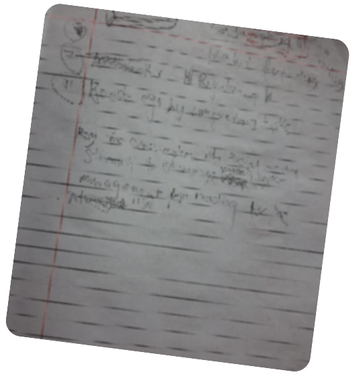
How might we statement

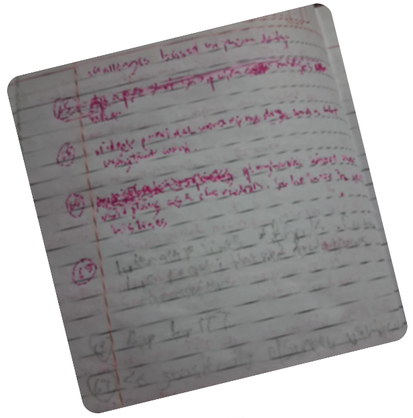
How might we make early fitness progress visible so gym goers stay motivated before physical changes appear?

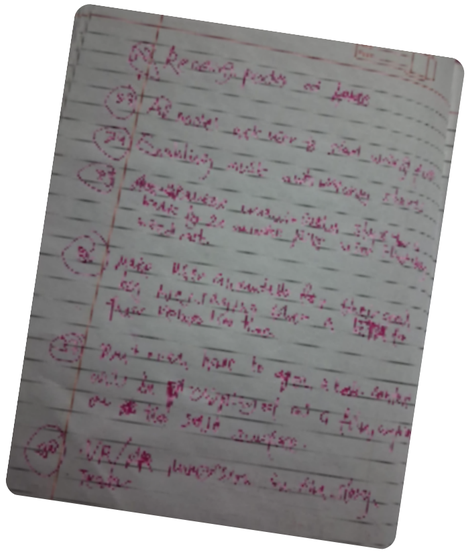


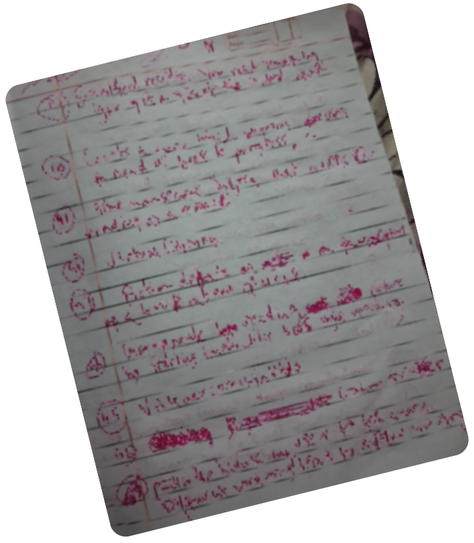
Ideations

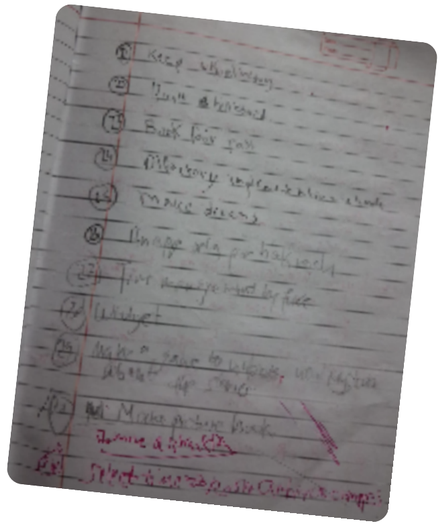
52 ideations done

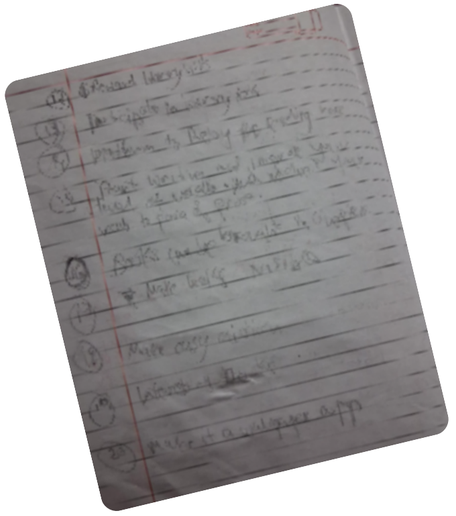


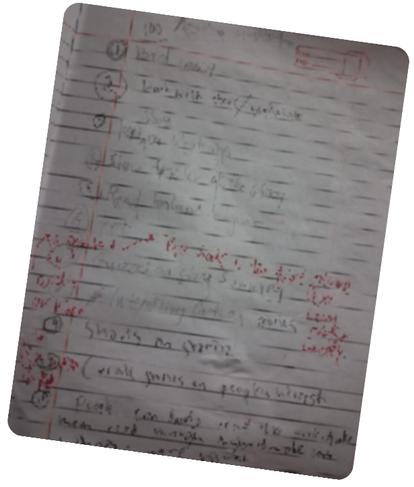




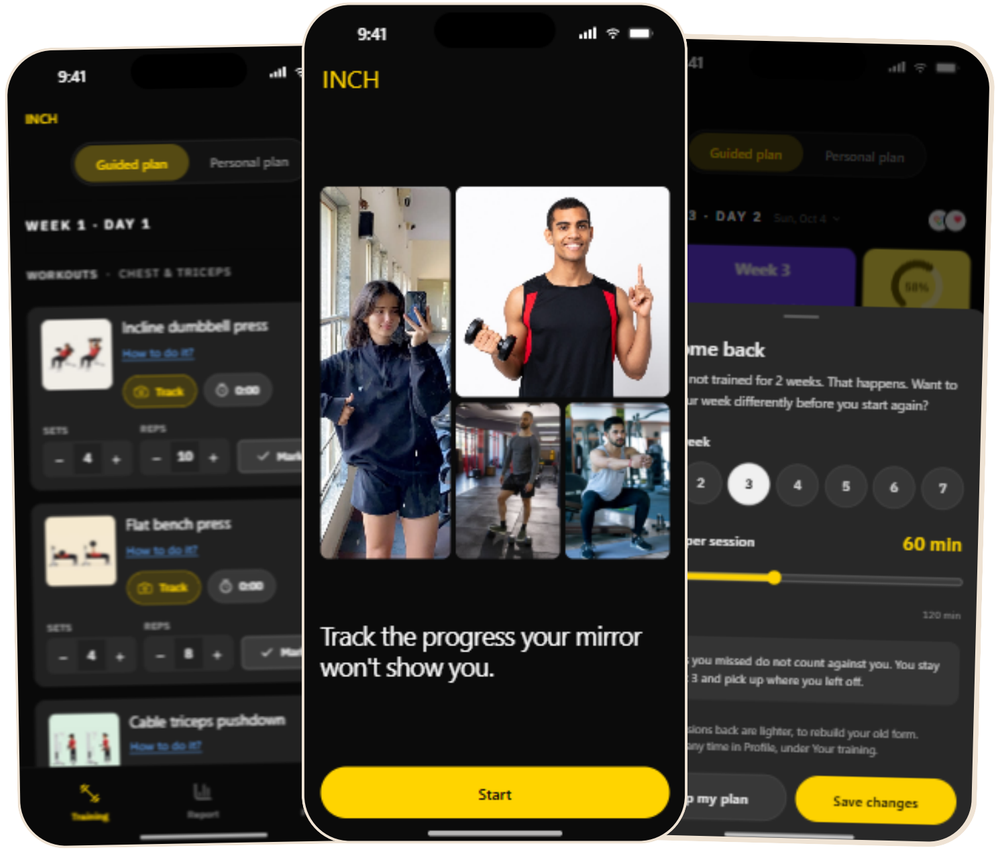








Final Solution



WINNING IDEA

INCH

INCH tracks your workouts to show the physiological improvements happening inside your body.

Changes begin from week one but remain invisible to the naked eye. **INCH** makes your unseen progress visible before it ever shows up in the mirror.

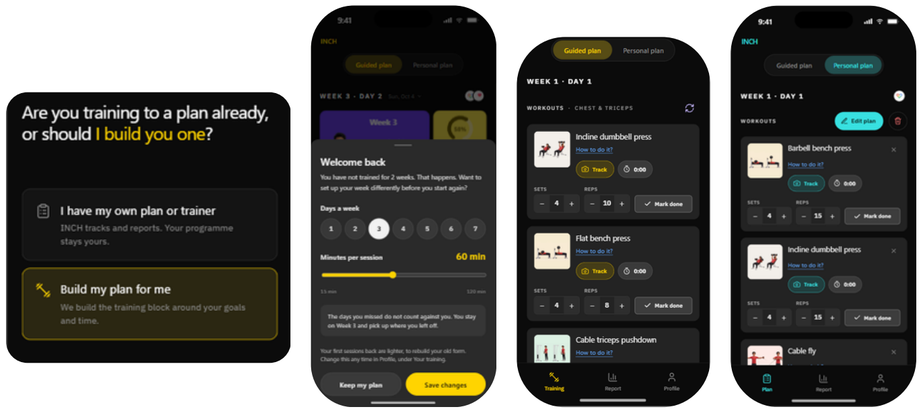
I have attached the prototype link at page 17

Key features

1

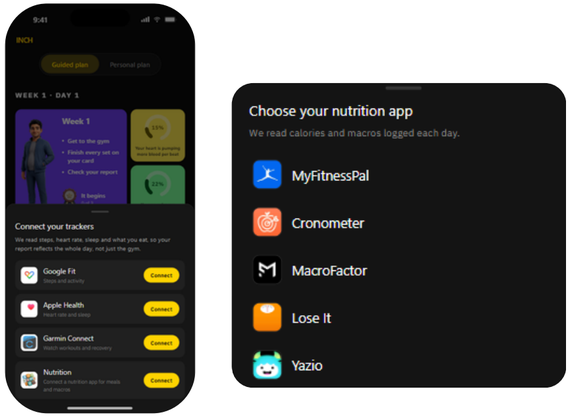
Shows micro-improvement reports happening in the body based on the user's workout and lifestyle patterns.

2



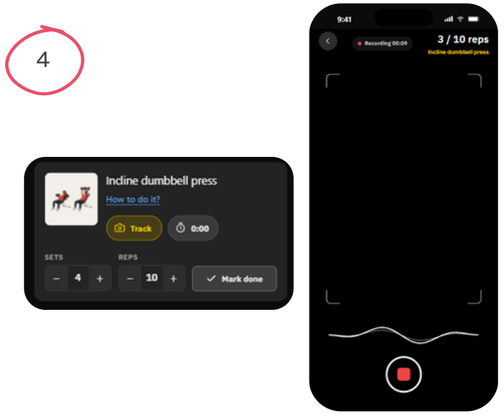
Dual exercise setup: create your own routine or get a customized plan based on your goals and commitments.

3



Connecting with external trackers to track the overall lifestyle of the user for precise report and guidance

4



Exercise tracking camera with voice guidance for accurate tracking of reps

5

Avatar which dynamically changes body shape and expressions based on the user's workout logins

Projected Impact

Change in narrative about “Results”, from a final output standpoint to improving overall health through regular workouts in cadence

Lesser beginner dropouts because they know that their efforts are improving their overall health, beyond their physical appearance

Makes returning after a gap non punitive by gradually rebuilding previous form before resuming the original plan.

Business model

1

Playing contextually relevant ads in app

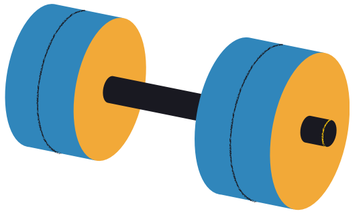
2

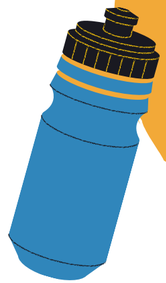
Recommends relevant fitness products based on users’ progression needs.

Prototype links

Link 1 – **Click for the main flow**

Link 2 – Click for flow of user returning to the Gym After a Gap





Thank you !!